



American Psychology-Law Society

APA DIVISION 41

Welcome to the February 2023

American Psychology-Law Society (AP-LS) Newsletter

Our monthly newsletter provides information about activities, upcoming events, and resources to connect the psychology-law community.

AP-LS aspires to excel as a valuable, effective, and influential organization advancing the science of psychology-law and the translation of psychology-law knowledge into practice and policy.



Legal Update:

Juror Questions in Civil Cases:

Opening Pandora's Box or Newest Tool for Juror
Engagement? Undergraduate Research Grants in Aid

Picture a witness getting questioned on the stand. Did you think of *My Cousin Vinny* or *Law & Order: SVU*? Chances are you imagined a dramatic moment where the lawyer asks the one question that blows the case wide open. But what if jurors could ask questions as well?

Despite being an experienced trial attorney in both federal and state court with a master's degree in legal and forensic psychology, it was not until last summer during a two-week trial in Dallas County that I experienced this practice first-hand. This trial was an opportunity for me to expand my jury science specialty, specifically in regard to the practice of jurors asking questions—through the judge—during trial. While juror questioning varies greatly depending on the courtroom due to judicial discretion, but, generally, judges who allow the practice ask jury members to write any outstanding questions they have for a witness at the end of the attorney-led examination and any questions not objected to by attorneys are then asked of the witness by the judge. This practice balances juror anonymity and neutrality while also leading to an overall increased level of engagement and dedication of the jury.

This article discusses the historical context of juror questioning, as well as the benefits, concerns, and the practical implications for civil cases. At bottom, the practice of jurors asking questions does not appear to be subsiding. In fact, it continues to grow—judges, lawyers, witnesses, and prospective jurors should all be aware of what this looks like for the future.

[Read the Full Article](#)

Call for Co-Chairs for 2024 AP-LS Conference

The AP-LS Conference Advisory Committee (CAC) is seeking two interested professionals to co-chair the **March 2024 Annual Conference** in Los Angeles. We encourage self-nominations across all areas of clinical and research expertise. The CAC will select one representative from the clinical arena and one from the experimental/research arena to co-chair the conference. Individuals and pairs are encouraged to apply. While pair preferences will be considered, we cannot guarantee selection together and individuals may be chosen instead.

Please submit your nomination, including a **Letter of Intent and Curriculum Vitae** by **February 28, 2023**.

Please contact Dr. Nick Druhn, CAC Chair, at druhnn@icloud.com with any questions.

[Submit Your Nominations](#)

Career Corner

The Career Corner is intended to highlight the individuals who work at the intersection of law and psychology, where they come from, how they got there, and how their experiences influence their research, teaching, and/or practice. This edition of Career Corner profiles Lauren Gonzales, Ph.D., Assistant Professor of Medical Psychology (in Psychiatry) at Columbia University Irving Medical Center. Her research focuses on social determinants of mental health including recovery and community integration of individuals with mental illness diagnoses in civil and criminal legal settings.

[Read the Column](#)

Call for Book Proposals

The American Psychology-Law Society invites proposals for new titles in its book series, which is now published by [APA Books](#). We publish authored and edited volumes on current issues at the intersection of psychology and law. Books are typically a state-of-the-science synthesis of a body of existing research with implications for practice and/or policy.

Authors and editors should have a substantial and recent track record of publication and/or practice in psychology or law, and at least one should hold a doctorate in psychology or closely related behavioral science. If you have a proposal for a new book in the series or you would simply like more information, reach out to a member of the editorial team. We would be happy to tell you more.

The editorial board members are:

- Monica Miller, Division 41 Book Series Editor (mkmiller@unr.edu)
- Monique Bowen, Division 41 Book Series Associate Editor (mbowen2@antioch.edu)
- Jemour Maddux, Division 41 Book Series Associate Editor (jm@rule702.com)

Psychology, Public Policy, and Law Call for Papers on Emerging Issues in Correctional Policy, Research, and Practice

Guest Editors:

Ashley B. Batastini, Ph.D.
University of Memphis

Jennifer Eno Loudon, Ph.D.
The University of Texas at El Paso

Virginia Barber-Rioja, Ph.D.
Correctional Health Services/NYC Health + Hospitals

Correctional institutions and departments are often slow-moving regarding practice developments, policy reform, and research engagement. Long-standing issues such as prison over-crowding, limited financial resources, geographical remoteness, low staff recruitment and retention, safety and security constraints, and traditional administrative values that favor punishment over rehabilitation can stifle the implementation of more innovative and progressive efforts. However, the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic and increasing calls from advocacy groups, politicians, and the general public have placed pressures on correctional systems to explore alternative solutions that balance crime reduction with humane care and commonsense policies. As jails and prisons continue to serve as major mental health providers, innovations specific to psychological interventions are especially relevant.

This special section will highlight emerging issues and inventive trends in correctional psychology research and practice that can inform policy decisions and reform efforts. Original quantitative and/or qualitative research is strongly

encouraged; however, empirically grounded systematic reviews or policy/practice recommendations will also be considered. Manuscripts focused on all areas of corrections are welcome, but topics of particular interest include:

- Technological advances that improve access to and delivery of correctional practices or policy implementation
- Integrating social justice principles in assessment and intervention for clients in correctional settings
- Mental and behavioral health responses to COVID-19 in correctional settings
- Creative approaches to addressing and reducing the jail-based competency crisis
- Validation of novel and feasible suicide and violence risk instruments with correctional samples
- Medication assisted treatment and other innovative substance use interventions
- Adaptation or development of evidence-based assessment or interventions for underserved and understudied populations (e.g., people with neurodevelopmental disorders, women and non-binary people, LGBTQIA+ persons, people of color, etc.)
- Unique methodological or statistical approaches to conducting correctional research or evaluating the effectiveness of new policies

For general inquiries, prospective contributors may contact Dr. Ashley Batastini (Ashley.batastini@memphis.edu).

Manuscripts must be submitted through the journal's online submission portal in accordance with specified formatting guidelines. Once in the portal, there will be a drop-down option to designate your submission for consideration in this special section. The deadline for submissions is **March 15, 2023**.

Register for AP-LS 2023

The registration portal for the **2023 AP-LS Conference** (from March 16 to March 18, 2023) at the Philadelphia Downtown Marriott is still open. Pre-conference workshops will be held on **March 15, 2023**.

To register for the conference (including pre-conference workshops), book your room, request a satellite event (e.g., evening social), or sign up for the 5K Fun Run, [please go to the AP-LS website](#).

Please register by **February 13**. Also, please note that the deadline to reserve a room at the conference hotel (for the group rate) is **February 20**.

All presenting authors were recently emailed additional information and a speaker agreement form; please complete the speaker form as soon as you can. If you did not receive an email, please check your spam folder first, then email office@ap-ls.org.

Within the coming weeks, all symposia presenting authors will receive an emailed link to upload a draft version of their slides, containing at least a title slide and a slide addressing potential conflicts of interest by **February 13**. This requirement is so that we can offer much-needed CE credits to attending practitioners.

A scheduling grid with keynote presentations, presenting author last names and session times, as well as special events has been posted to the conference webpage. The full program will be posted in the coming weeks. Please continue to check the [website](#) for additional conference-related updates.

Any questions regarding conference programming can be sent to the Conference Co-Chairs, Andrea Avila and Miko M. Wilford, at conference@ap-ls.org. All other queries (including logistical, hotel, satellite event and registration-related questions) can be sent to the AP-LS office at office@ap-ls.org.

Register for the Conference

On the Job or Postdoc Market? AP-LS Job Postings



Check out [AP-LS's Job Postings Page](#) for up-to-date information on available psychology-law positions.

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Membership Services

AP-LS seeks to advance the science of psychology-law and the translation of psychology-law knowledge into practice. Our mission is to enhance the well-being, justice, and human rights through science and practice of psychology in legal contexts.

Newsletter Archives

Archives of the newsletter are available at ap-ls.org/newsletter.

